

What are the rules you should use to make sure a DoView strategy diagram is fit-for-purpose for planning?

When you build a DoView strategy/outcomes diagram for use in DoView Planning, you need to build it in a specific structured way so that it will work when used in all of the tools within the approach. These include: priority setting; identifying indicators; visualizing alignment between activities and priorities; working out how to assess impact; delegation and contracting; assigning accountabilities; and, reporting.

This DoView Drawing Rules Tool (B7) gives you a clear set of rules for building such diagrams. The first reason for drawing your diagrams according to these rules is that you can be confident that your diagram is going to be fit for purpose for all of the ways you might want to use it in DoView Planning. Second, using the rules means that the diagrams are set out in a standardized format optimized for reader accessibility. Their drill-down structure is based on the principle of breaking the diagram up into subpage chunks that can be quickly and easily read and understood by lay readers. This means that the reader can quickly see what an agency, provider, policy or initiative is trying to achieve. They just need to look at the 'helicopter' overview and then to quickly drill-down into the subpage within the diagram. Third, the standardized format means that these diagrams' drill-down components can be easily compared and shared across different and agencies, providers, policies or initiatives for best practice sharing.

Sometimes you may get some people who are drawing DoView diagrams claiming things such as: 'the diagram can only contain boxes that are measurable' or 'everything in the diagram must be controllable by our initiative.' However, under the DoView Drawing Rules, boxes within a strategy/outcomes diagram do not need to be limited to either just measurable or controllable boxes. If you adopt an 'only measurable and only controllable' approach to diagram building, the diagram you build will not help you quickly identify what is currently NOT being measured and, secondly, they will not help you identify higher-level not-necessarily controllable indicators (outcomes) as discussed later. The rules in this tool have been carefully thought out to optimize the usefulness of the strategy/outcomes diagrams throughout all steps in DoView Planning.